PRACTICE EXAM 15 / EXAM SET 03

Domain 1: Foundational Knowledge and Basic Science

15 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Basic Pharmacology

> **SCENARIO** A verified prescription for an 8-year-old weighing 22 kg specifies cephalexin 25 mg/kg/day orally, divided into two equal doses. The suspension contains 250 mg per 5 mL. The medical assistant is trained and authorized to calculate and prepare the prescribed dose under applicable law and clinic policy.

What volume corresponds to one dose? Round to the nearest 0.1 mL; round a halfway value up.

A. 2.8 mL
B. 5.5 mL
C. 11 mL
D. 22 mL

Q02 | Medical Terminology

Which term uses a prefix meaning excessive or much to describe an abnormally increased volume of urine?

A. Oliguria.
B. Dysuria.
C. Polyuria.
D. Nocturia.

Q03 | Psychology

SCENARIO A patient acknowledges choosing to watch television instead of doing the exercises in an agreed rehabilitation plan. The patient then says, "Those exercises probably would not have helped anyway," using the explanation to justify the choice and reduce discomfort about it.

Which defense mechanism is best illustrated by this explanation?

A. Rationalization.
B. Displacement.
C. Projection.
D. Regression.

Q04 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO An oral medication is labeled as a suspension with instructions to shake well before measuring. After standing, it has a clearer upper layer and visible particles below. The product reference identifies this settling as expected and says the particles should redisperse with shaking.

Why is redistributing the particles important before a dose is measured?

A. It converts the product into a true solution by completely dissolving the drug.
B. It raises the product's concentration above the strength printed on the label.
C. It restores an even distribution of suspended drug for a consistent measured dose.
D. It extends the product's usable period beyond the labeled discard date.

Q05 | Health Care Systems and Settings

SCENARIO A practice's new personnel roster has one column labeled State License. A staff member enters every national certification number in that column, including CCMA credentials. The roster will be used to verify staff qualifications.

Which correction best preserves the distinction between certification and licensure?

A. Keep the entries because a national certification number serves as a state license number.
B. Record national certifications separately and verify governmental licenses through the appropriate licensing authority when required.
C. Move the certification numbers into the supervising physician's license record.
D. Replace the state-license heading with employee number and use that column for both credentials.

Q06 | Nutrition

SCENARIO A patient's existing celiac disease nutrition plan excludes wheat, barley, and rye. The patient brings a drink labeled wheat-free, but its ingredient list includes barley malt extract.

Which explanation best connects this label finding to the patient's plan?

A. Wheat-free does not establish suitability because the listed barley ingredient conflicts with the plan.
B. Wheat-free establishes suitability because the plan's other grain restrictions apply only to solid foods.
C. The drink fits the plan if its total sugar content is lower than that of a regular soft drink.
D. The drink fits the plan if it is taken with a meal rather than between meals.

Q07 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO A medication's manufacturer label states, "Protect from light. Keep in the original light-resistant container." A staff member suggests moving the stock into clear, labeled jars on an open shelf to make inventory counting easier. No transfer has occurred.

Which storage decision follows the supplied product requirement?

A. Use clear jars if the room temperature remains within the labeled range.
B. Use clear jars if each jar retains the drug name and expiration date.
C. Use clear jars on the open shelf if the original carton is kept elsewhere.
D. Keep the stock in its original light-resistant container as directed.

Q08 | Medical Terminology

SCENARIO A provider's note describes a left wrist injury and discomfort in the ipsilateral shoulder. The assistant is checking which shoulder the note refers to before preparing the examination room.

Which shoulder is identified by ipsilateral in this note?

A. The left shoulder, on the same side as the injured wrist.
B. The right shoulder, on the opposite side from the injured wrist.
C. Both shoulders, regardless of the side of the injured wrist.
D. The shoulder with greater discomfort, regardless of the side of the injured wrist.

Q09 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO Before preparing a newly ordered oral amoxicillin dose, an authorized and trained medical assistant checks the allergy record. It documents previous anaphylaxis to penicillin. The patient confirms that history, and the order does not address it. No dose has been given.

Which action appropriately addresses this medication-safety concern?

A. Prepare the dose because the current drug name differs from the allergy entry.
B. Replace the ordered medicine with another antibiotic that is available in stock.
C. Prepare a smaller test dose to see whether the patient tolerates the medicine.
D. Pause preparation and notify the prescribing clinician of the documented serious allergy.

Q10 | Health Care Systems and Settings

SCENARIO A clinician requests individualized nutrition therapy for a patient who has both diabetes and chronic kidney disease. The patient needs a detailed eating plan that accounts for the two conditions, and the assistant is identifying the appropriate referral professional.

Which professional has the most directly relevant expertise for this request?

A. A radiologic technologist.
B. A physical therapist.
C. A registered dietitian.
D. A medical laboratory technician.

Q11 | Medical Terminology

SCENARIO A verified order specifies a dose of one-half milligram. The clinic's documentation policy requires a leading zero for a dose below 1 mg and prohibits unnecessary trailing zeros. The assistant must enter the dose without changing its value.

Which entry follows both parts of the stated policy?

A. .5 mg
B. 0.5 mg
C. 0.50 mg
D. 5 mg

Q12 | Health Care Systems and Settings

> **SCENARIO** After surgery, a patient is referred for intermittent skilled nursing visits and physical therapy delivered in the patient's own residence. The provider's plan focuses on recovery and regaining function; it does not describe terminal-illness comfort care.

Which service best matches this referral?

A. Residential hospice care.
B. An inpatient rehabilitation admission.
C. Home health care.
D. A mobile neighborhood screening clinic.

Q13 | Nutrition

> **SCENARIO** A patient already takes a multivitamin containing preformed vitamin A as retinyl palmitate and wants to add a separate supplement containing the same ingredient. The patient says, "Any extra vitamin will just leave in my urine." The combined intake has not been reviewed by the care team.

Which property best explains why the combined vitamin A intake needs review?

A. Preformed vitamin A is a source of dietary protein, so it duplicates the patient's protein intake.
B. Preformed vitamin A is rapidly cleared in urine, so long-term intake does not affect body stores.
C. Preformed vitamin A is fat soluble and can accumulate in body stores, particularly the liver.
D. Preformed vitamin A acts as dietary fiber, so it prevents absorption of the other supplement.

Q14 | Psychology

> **SCENARIO** At a wellness visit, a 78-year-old talks about past work, family relationships, and mistakes. The patient says, "My life has had difficult parts, but I can accept the choices I made and see meaning in it."

In Erikson's psychosocial framework, which developmental task is most closely reflected in this statement?

A. Developing ego integrity rather than despair.
B. Developing basic trust rather than mistrust.
C. Developing industry rather than inferiority.
D. Developing identity rather than role confusion.

Q15 | Basic Pharmacology

> **SCENARIO** A patient prescribed an ondansetron orally disintegrating tablet assumes it must be held under the tongue as a sublingual medicine. The product instructions instead say to place it on top of the tongue, allow it to dissolve, and swallow with saliva.

Which explanation correctly distinguishes this formulation and route?

A. It is a sublingual formulation intended to remain under the tongue until absorbed.

B. It is a buccal formulation intended to remain between the cheek and gum until absorbed.

C. It is a chewable oral formulation that must be broken down by chewing before swallowing.

D. It is an oral formulation that disintegrates on the tongue and is swallowed as the label describes.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

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01 B	02 C	03 A	04 C	05 B	06 A
07 D	08 A	09 D	10 C	11 B	12 C
13 C	14 A	15 D			

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: B

5.5 mL

The total daily amount is 25 mg/kg/day x 22 kg = 550 mg/day. Divide by two doses to obtain 275 mg per dose, then calculate (275 mg / 250 mg) x 5 mL = 5.5 mL per dose. Giving 11 mL at each administration would give the entire daily amount twice.

Q02 | Correct answer: C

Polyuria.

Poly- means much or excessive, and -uria refers to urine or urination, so polyuria describes increased urine volume. Dysuria describes painful or difficult urination; oliguria indicates reduced urine output, while nocturia refers to urination at night.

Q03 | Correct answer: A

Rationalization.

Rationalization uses a seemingly acceptable explanation to justify a behavior or reduce discomfort about it. The patient is explaining away the choice, rather than redirecting an emotion toward another target or attributing a feeling to someone else.

Q04 | Correct answer: C

It restores an even distribution of suspended drug for a consistent measured dose.

A suspension contains dispersed particles that can settle, so the supplied instructions call for redistributing them before measuring. A sample from an uneven mixture may contain an unintended amount of drug; shaking does not turn the product into a true solution or extend its discard date.

Q05 | Correct answer: B

Record national certifications separately and verify governmental licenses through the appropriate licensing authority when required.

National certification and governmental licensure are different types of credentials and should be identified accurately. A CCMA certification number is not evidence of a state-issued license; any license required for a role must be verified through its licensing authority.

Q06 | Correct answer: A

Wheat-free does not establish suitability because the listed barley ingredient conflicts with the plan.

The supplied plan excludes barley as well as wheat and rye, and the ingredient list identifies barley malt extract. A wheat-free claim addresses only wheat; sugar content, liquid form, or timing does not resolve the stated ingredient conflict.

Q07 | Correct answer: D

Keep the stock in its original light-resistant container as directed.

The label specifically requires the original light-resistant container, so the proposed transfer would remove a required storage protection. Correct temperature and identification labels do not substitute for protection from light.

Q08 | Correct answer: A

The left shoulder, on the same side as the injured wrist.

Ipsilateral means on the same side of the body, so the left wrist reference identifies the left shoulder. Contralateral would indicate the opposite side, while bilateral would refer to both sides.

Q09 | Correct answer: D

Pause preparation and notify the prescribing clinician of the documented serious allergy.

Amoxicillin is a penicillin-class antibiotic, and a history of penicillin anaphylaxis is a serious concern that must be resolved before proceeding. The assistant should flag the order and allergy for the prescriber, rather than independently substituting a medicine or attempting a test dose.

Q10 | Correct answer: C

A registered dietitian.

A registered dietitian has expertise in assessing nutritional needs and providing individualized medical nutrition therapy. The assistant can help arrange the referral and reinforce the resulting instructions, but should not independently design a diet for multiple medical conditions.

Q11 | Correct answer: B

0.5 mg

The entry 0.5 mg retains the ordered half-milligram dose, includes the required leading zero, and avoids an unnecessary trailing zero. Omitting the leading zero or adding a trailing zero violates the supplied policy; 5 mg would change the dose tenfold.

Q12 | Correct answer: C

Home health care.

Home health care can provide ordered nursing and therapy services in a patient's residence. The referral describes recovery services at home, rather than an inpatient admission, a mobile screening site, or a hospice plan; it does not establish any particular payer's eligibility requirements.

Q13 | Correct answer: C

Preformed vitamin A is fat soluble and can accumulate in body stores, particularly the liver.

Preformed vitamin A is fat soluble, and excess intake can accumulate, especially in the liver, with potential toxicity. The assistant should record both products for clinician or dietitian review rather than assuming that excess vitamin A is promptly eliminated or recommending an additional dose.

Q14 | Correct answer: A

Developing ego integrity rather than despair.

Ego integrity involves reflecting on one's life with a sense of acceptance and meaning, even when it includes difficulties. Erikson associated integrity versus despair with later adulthood; the other choices describe tasks associated with earlier developmental periods.

Q15 | Correct answer: D

It is an oral formulation that disintegrates on the tongue and is swallowed as the label describes.

The supplied instructions identify an orally administered product that disintegrates on the tongue and is then swallowed. Dissolving in the mouth does not by itself make a tablet sublingual or buccal; the assistant should reinforce the instructions for the specific formulation.

End of Practice Exam